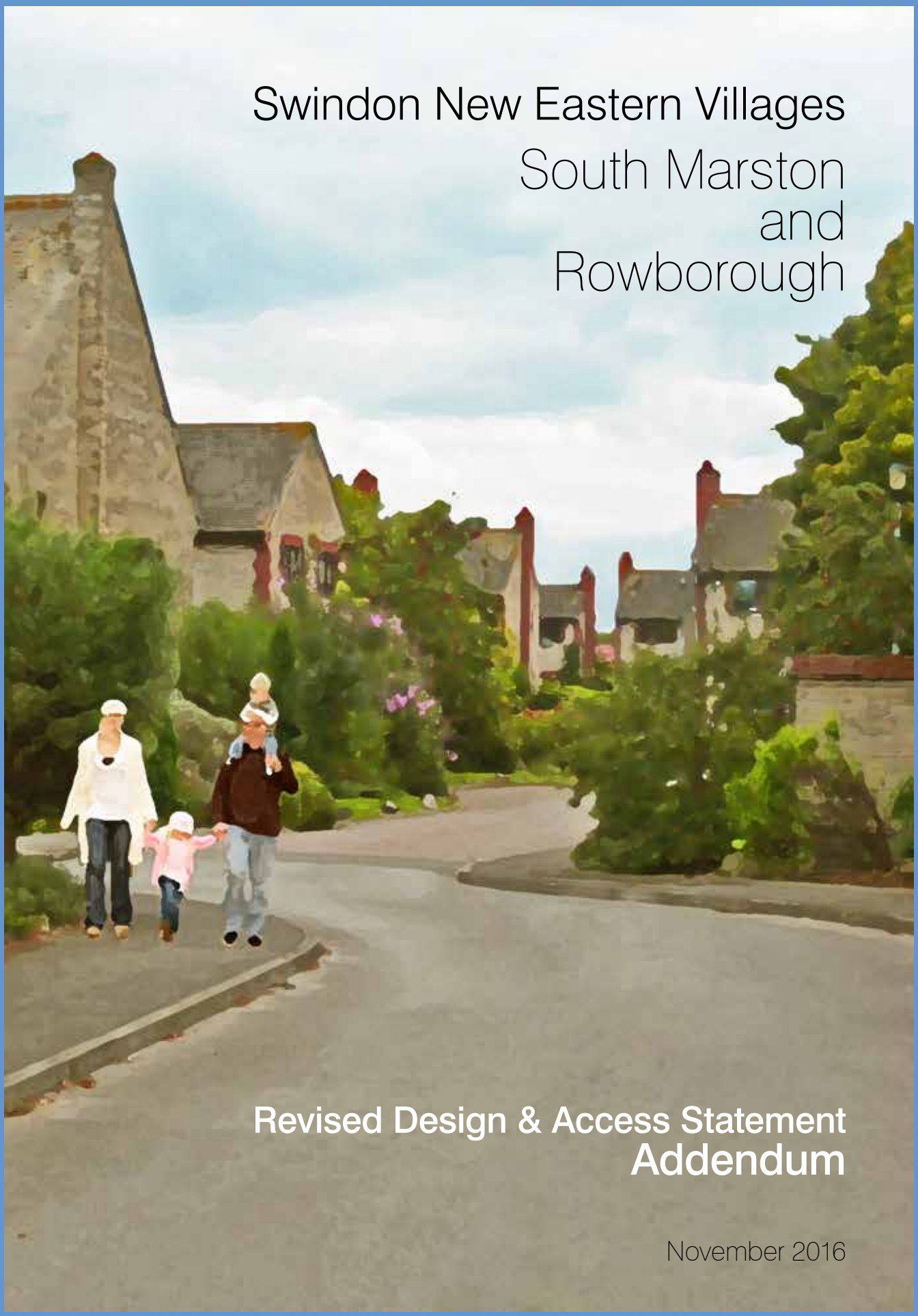


Swindon New Eastern Villages

South Marston and Rowborough

Revised Design & Access Statement Addendum

November 2016

Introduction

This Revised Design and Access Statement (DAS) Addendum is submitted to Swindon Borough Council in support of the outline planning application (LPA ref: S/13/1555) for the development of the initial phase of the Swindon New Eastern Villages sustainable urban extension, on behalf of Hallam Land Management Limited, Hannick Homes & Developments Limited, and Taylor Wimpey UK Limited (HHT). The submission is made by a project team comprising David Lock Associates (town planning and masterplanning), Brookbanks Consulting (transportation, infrastructure, hydrology and ground conditions), FPCR Environment and Design (landscape and ecology), and Orion Heritage Limited (archaeology and historic environment).

The Revised DAS Addendum provides additional information in response to consultation with stakeholders, statutory consultees and other interested parties and seeks to clarify points of detail and provides additional information as appropriate. Where an update has been made by way of additional written explanation or an amended plan or drawing the full page is reproduced and cross referenced to the section and page numbering in the Revised DAS dated April 2016. This DAS Addendum must be read in conjunction with that document.

The DAS Addendum provides further information to demonstrate a robust scheme for a sustainable urban extension at South Marston and Rowborough. It supports the overarching housing and development objectives of the Borough Council as set out in the adopted Local Plan, as well as the aspirations of South Marston Parish Council in the submission draft Neighbourhood Plan. It also reflects a strong commitment by the applicants to the delivery of a high-quality environment that is strongly informed by the character of the area.

Summary of Key Amendments

Page No.	Plan Ref.	Summary of amendment
Section 3 – Context Appraisal		
Page 28	None	Updated to reflect submission of additional information in respect of assessment of heritage settings, undertaken by Orion Heritage Limited . Additional Heritage Information, September 2016. Assessment included consideration of the setting of Church of St Mary Magdalene, Manor Farmhouse, The Red House and Nightingale Farm.
Section 4 – Design Evolution		
Page 37	Fig 008 Development Framework Plan	Principal changes to the Development Framework Plan include: • Refinements to the development parcel adjacent to Manor Farm to provide wider green corridor within centre of expanded village • Reorganisation of formal open spaces within Rowborough to remove allotments from Historic area of landfill • Amendment to the design of the OVL (northern) junction in consultation with SBC highways • Minor adjustment to the location of the A420 underbridge in consultation with Network Rail. • Removal of one of the two location options for community building within the application site.
Page 38	Fig 009 Illustrative Master Plan	In addition to the changes made to reflect amendments to the DFP, further changes to the Illustrative Masterplan include: • Further consideration of the foot/cycle network and connections to the existing Public Rights of Way network, to include provision of enhanced access to the proposed footbridge over railway; and • Illustrating potential vehicular accesses to Oxleaze Farm, Marston Farm and Nightingale Wood. The applicants are willing to accept an appropriately worded condition to ensure that reserved matters submission are broadly in accordance with the Illustrative Master Plan.
Section 5 – Design and Access		
Page 40	None	Updated to reflect the minor change to the land use budget (residential and open space) as a result of the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 43	None	Updated to reflect the minor change to the open space provision as a result of the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 45	Fig 010 Development Framework Plan with key	Updated as described above
Page 49	Fig 012 – Indicative Landscape and Green Space Infrastructure	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan

Page 52	Fig 013 – Proposed Landscape Zones	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 53	Fig 014 – Zone 1 South Marston	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 53	Fig 015 – South Marston Greenspace Area "Indicative" Zones	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 54	Fig 016 – Zone 2 Rowborough	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 54	Fig 017 – Rowborough Greenspace Area "Indicative" Zones	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 55	Fig 018 – Zone 3 Nightingale	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 55	Fig 019 – Nightingale Greenspace Area "Indicative" Zones	Updated to reflect the amendments to the Master Plan
Page 63	Fig 020- Indicative Access and Movement Strategy	In addition to the changes made to reflect amendments to the DFP, further changes Indicative Access and Movement Strategy include: • Further consideration of the foot/cycle network and connections to the existing Public Rights of Way network, to include provision of enhanced access to the proposed footbridge over railway; and • Illustrating potential vehicular accesses to Oxleaze Farm, Marston Farm and Nightingale Wood.
Section 6 – Illustrative Master Plan		
Page 75	Figure 012 – Illustrative Master Plan	Updated as described above
Page 80	None	Updated to include an additional bullet point that refers to consideration of the setting of Nightingale Farmhouse as part of detailed design proposals.
Page 85	Figure 025 - Community Building Location within the application site	Updated to reflect removal of one of the two location options for community building within the application site. Option for building on Parish Council Land is also retained.

Page 87	None	Update to include additional bullet points that refer to consideration of the setting of The Red House and Manor Farmhouse, as part of detailed design proposals.
Page 91	Figure 026 Illustrative Plan of Main Street and Manor Green junction	Plan to illustrate a potential layout to incorporate existing and proposed access points to Main Street and development parcels at Manor Green, and retaining private access to South Marston Farm and PRoW (fp4).

Archaeology and Historic Environment

Designated Heritage Assets. There are no scheduled monuments, registered parks and gardens, battlefields or conservation areas within the application site. There are a number of listed buildings in close proximity. These are:

- Priory Farmhouse. Grade II. Mid 17th century.
- Manor Farmhouse. Grade II. Late 17th/early 18th century.
- The Red House. Grade II. Early 19th century.
- Nightingale Farmhouse. Grade II. Early 19th century
- St Mary Magdalen Church. Grade I, 15th century
- Church Farm. Grade II, early 19th century
- Longleaze Farm. Grade II
- Marston Farmhouse. Grade II

Non-Designated Heritage Assets. A detailed geophysical survey of the areas of the site considered to have the highest potential for archaeological remains has been undertaken. The survey recorded a set of anomalies of archaeological origin around South Marston Farm. This is in the broad location of an area identified within the Swindon Local Plan as a significant unscheduled archaeological feature. Anomalies have also been identified south of Nightingale Lane.

A significant amount of intrusive archaeological work has been undertaken following submission of the planning application, and in accordance with a written scheme of investigation agreed with Wiltshire Council and Swindon Borough Council.

A revised Heritage Assessment has been submitted and presents a comprehensive update to include assessment of the built heritage as well as results of geophysical survey and trenching. This forms Appendix 8 of the Environmental Statement Further Information Report, April 2016.

Design Response. The archaeological remains recorded within the application site are all in arable fields and are subject to regular ploughing. A programme of appropriate investigations will continue to inform how remains may best be recorded as part of the overall development of the application site.

Additional heritage information has been provided to supplement the outline planning application, and its an addendum to the Environmental Statement. The information was requested by the Borough Council's conservation officer to examine any potential effects to the significance of the grade I listed Church of St Mary Magdalene, specifically the experience of the church tower from the surrounding area.

In addition, the heritage information looked at whether there was a need to delineate areas if sensitive heritage setting around key listed building to ensure that any development within those areas is designed in a manner that minimises any effects, where this is necessary. Manor Farmhouse, The Red House and Nightingale Farm were among those specifically considered.

The assessment of the Church of St Mary Magdalene concluded that the proposed design, layout and retention of open space around the church would not affect any key views, impede the experience of the church's wider setting, and not harm the significance of the church.

Of the listed buildings, the design and layout of proposals, including the landscape framework and retention of hedges and existing vegetation in key locations, would ensure that a good design response at reserved matters stage would preserve or enhance their setting such that no unacceptable harm would arise. In conclusion the proposed development would not result in any unacceptable harm to the historic buildings identified.

Design Response. Nightingale Farm will retain a substantial undeveloped and landscaped setting. The immediate setting of Manor Farmhouse is an important contributor to its significance and as a result an area of Sensitive Heritage Setting has been delineated around it. The purpose of delineation is to ensure that the detailed design at reserved matters stage is more carefully considered. The Red House and the Manor Farmhouse are part of an identified character area within the illustrative masterplan for which additional design guidance is given.

The application proposals make provision for an appropriate and effective movement network to serve the proposed development – in particular in relation to the expanded South Marston village.

It is not part of the application proposals to deliver a complete northern loop road to the north of the Manor Farm complex. The applicants cannot deliver a connection across the private rights of way that exist in particular between Old Vicarage Lane (South of the Hotel) and the Manor Farm buildings group, and there are other private rights of way.

However the application proposals seek to facilitate a northern loop road around Manor Farm. The DFP demonstrates a willingness by the applicants to facilitate such a connection by providing a road link to a point close to the track on either side, albeit not across the track. The illustrative master plan also illustrates the potential to provide such a road link to a point close to the track, albeit not across it. Such a connection across the track would need to be made by Swindon Borough Council, and/or third party. Regardless of whether vehicular connection is made, the transport and pedestrian/cycle connections will be extensive and provide excellent connectivity within the expanded village. Any further connection to Old Vicarage Lane that crosses the same or other tracks with private rights of way would require the same approach.

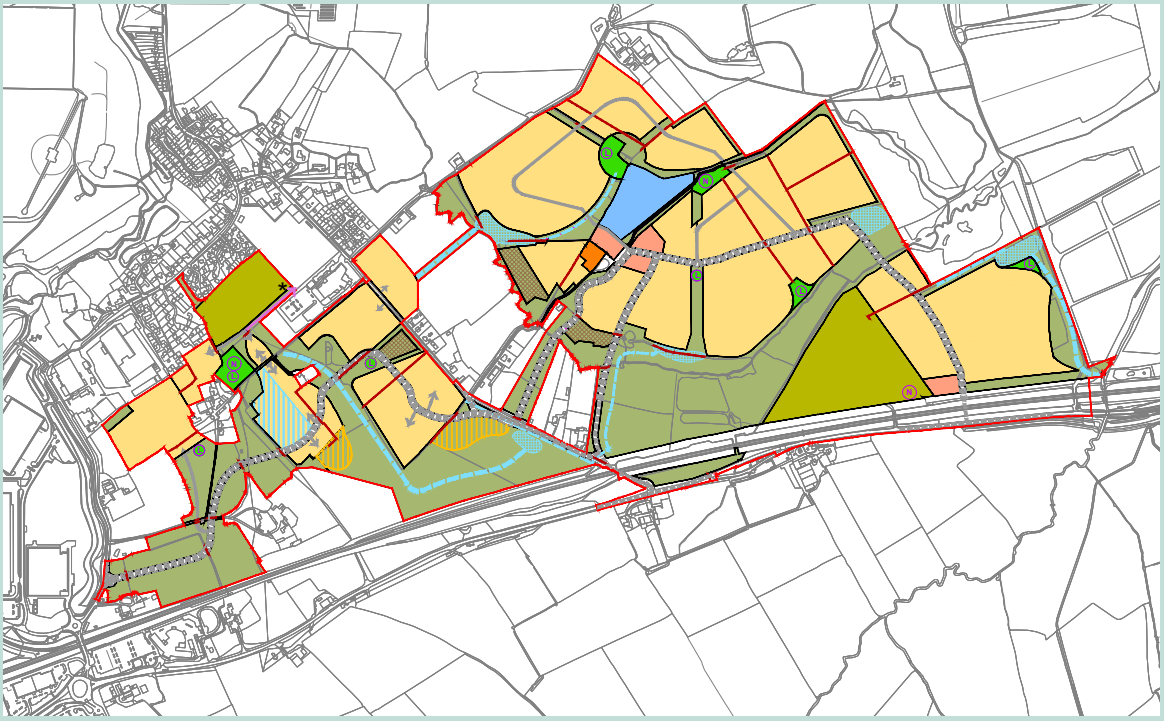


Fig 008 : Revised Development Framework Plan

Fig 009 : Revised Illustrative Master Plan

Illustrative Master Plan

The illustrative master plan refines the concepts established through the design process to date. Key features of the illustrative master plan comprise:

- Open Space and Green Infrastructure framework providing a setting for South Marston and for the new development of the village expansion and Rowborough, recognising view corridors and consideration of edge treatments .
- Clear linkages to the open countryside and areas of community woodland including retention of key areas of hedgerows and trees where consistant with the overall design and a new valley park around the South Marston Brook and further landscape mitigation and enhancement.
- Areas of formal and informal open space and pitch provision, including allotments and gardens.
- An appropriate and effective movement network to serve the development with extensive pedestrian/cycle routes and connectivity. The main street, the primary street, will be designed as a street with development frontage, supporting public transport. It is not part of the proposals to deliver a complete secondary route north of the Manor Farm complex at South Marston (see page 37).
- A mixed-use neighbourhood hub in Rowborough providing a community focus and new school and other facilities. A secondary mixed use area at Rowborough, associated with community and formal open space provision, to help establish a gateway at the south of the site.
- Enhanced community provision at South Marston.
- Discrete development parcels providing an opportunity for different character and providing a strong identity for the South Marston village expansion and Rowborough.
- Provision for flood attenuation and drainage as part of the open space network
- Provision of an indicative strategic footpath/ cycle network, illustrating connectivity between development parcels and to the existing Public Rights of Way network.
- Provision for further primary school and community facilities within the application site at South Marston and replacement residential land to be provided in the eventuality that school provision does not come forward on adjacent Parish Council land. (alternative layout option).

05 Design and Access

This section sets out the key design and access elements of the development proposals for South Marston and Rowborough. The Development Framework plan has been prepared in order to set out the key design and access elements of the scheme in the outline permission. The design and access elements comprise:

- **Amount** covering the mix and quantum of land uses;
- **Layout** of the application proposals;
- **Scale** of development in terms of height and density;
- **Landscape** framework and components;
- **Appearance** of the development having regard to local context;
- **Access** to the existing highway and footpath network; and
- **Sustainability** strategy for the site.

Amount

The application proposals comprise a residential led scheme together with a mixed use Neighbourhood 'hub' and smaller mixed use gateway at Rowborough, comprising for example community, health, employment, education and local retail uses, and formal and informal open space provision and opportunities for an expanded village centre at South Marston.

The amount of proposed development is set out in Table 1, and shown on the Development Framework Plan. The strategy relating to the built land uses is also described below.

- up to 2,380 residential dwellings (class C3);
- up to1,500 sqm of employment floor space (class B1);
- mixed use space for local retail and other services comprising up to 1,500 sqm of Use Class A1; with provision also and in addition for A2, A3, A4, and A5 uses.
- two primary schools, (one 1FE and one 2FE) (class D1);
- community and sport buildings (classes D1 and D2) ;
- sheltered/care ccommodation (class C2 and class C3) ;
- green infrastructure including formal pitches, informal open space, landscape areas, areas of biodiversity and children's play spaces;
- sustainable urban drainage systems including balancing ponds and drainage channels;
- connections to the surrounding highway, footpath and bridleway network;
- infrastructure and utilities provision including car parking; and
- ground remodelling, engineering works and demolition.

Table 1 : Amount

Land use budget

USE	AREA(HA)	TOTAL UNITS
Residential	64.7	2,380
Mixed use centre	1.40	0
Rowborough school South Marston and Rowborough schools (alternative scenario)	2.25 3.85	0 0
Open space & strategic landscaping (Green infrastructure included)	67 approx	0

Open Space

A generous landscape and open space Green Infrastructure Framework is a key part of the proposals for South Marston and Rowborough. The framework is structured around important landscape features, including watercourses and tree groups, and has been designed to ensure convenient accessibility for future residents to both formal and informal open space and playspaces.

In South Marston the main area of formal open space and pitch provision is centrally located between the existing village and the proposed village expansion. At Rowborough the primary area of formal open space and pitch provision is located to the south, with a secondary area to the west close to the mixed-use neighbourhood 'hub'.

Open space requirements from the Local Plan together with the proposed open space provision are set out in the table below. The figures are based on the housing numbers proposed in the outline application (1880 for Rowborough and 500 for South Marston). They are multiplied by the average household size for Swindon of 2.35 persons per household (as published in the Swindon Borough Interim Household Projects, April 2013). This equates to a population of 4,418 for Rowborough and 1,175 for South Marston (total 5,593).

CATEGORY OF OPEN SPACE	SWINDON BOROUGH PLAN 2026	REQUIREMENTS	PROPOSED
Open Space (overall)	3.2ha/1,000 population	17.9ha South Marston: 3.8ha Rowborough: 14.1ha	67ha (approximately) South Marston: 28ha Rowborough: 39ha
Children / Teen Play Areas	0.3ha/1,000 population (to include NEAP, LEAP, and LLA (Local Landscape Area)	1.7ha South Marston: 0.4ha Rowborough: 1.3ha	2.1ha (Included as part of overall general recreation areas) South Marston: 0.73ha Rowborough: 1.38ha
Outdoor Sports Facilities	1.6ha/1000 population (of which 1.2ha/1000 population are formal pitches)	8.9ha (6.7ha formal pitches) South Marston: 1.9ha (1.4ha formal pitches) Rowborough: 7.1ha (5.08ha formal pitches)	10.2ha South Marston: 2.9ha Rowborough: 7.3ha
General Recreation Areas	1ha/1,000 population (of which 0.5 ha/1,000 should be suitable for children's informal play)	5.6ha (2.8ha children's informal play) South Marston: 1.2ha (0.6ha children's informal play) Rowborough: 4.4ha (2.2ha children's informal play)	53ha (approximately) South Marston: 24ha Rowborough: 29ha
Allotments	0.3ha/1,000 population	1.7ha South Marston: 0.4ha Rowborough: 1.3ha	1.7ha South Marston: 0.4ha Rowborough: 1.3ha

- A variety of landscape and development responses to the existing character of the site, including a robust landscape framework, useable formal and informal open spaces, and the creation of sports pitches located in convenient and accessible locations. At South Marston pitches are located to provide recreation opportunities for the wider community as part of the village centre.

- Establish a rich and diverse green infrastructure strategy incorporating existing trees and hedgerows of value and connecting parks, play areas, formal sports pitches, and wildlife habitats and providing opportunities for mitigation where appropriate.

- Development will be served by an appropriate and effective movement network.

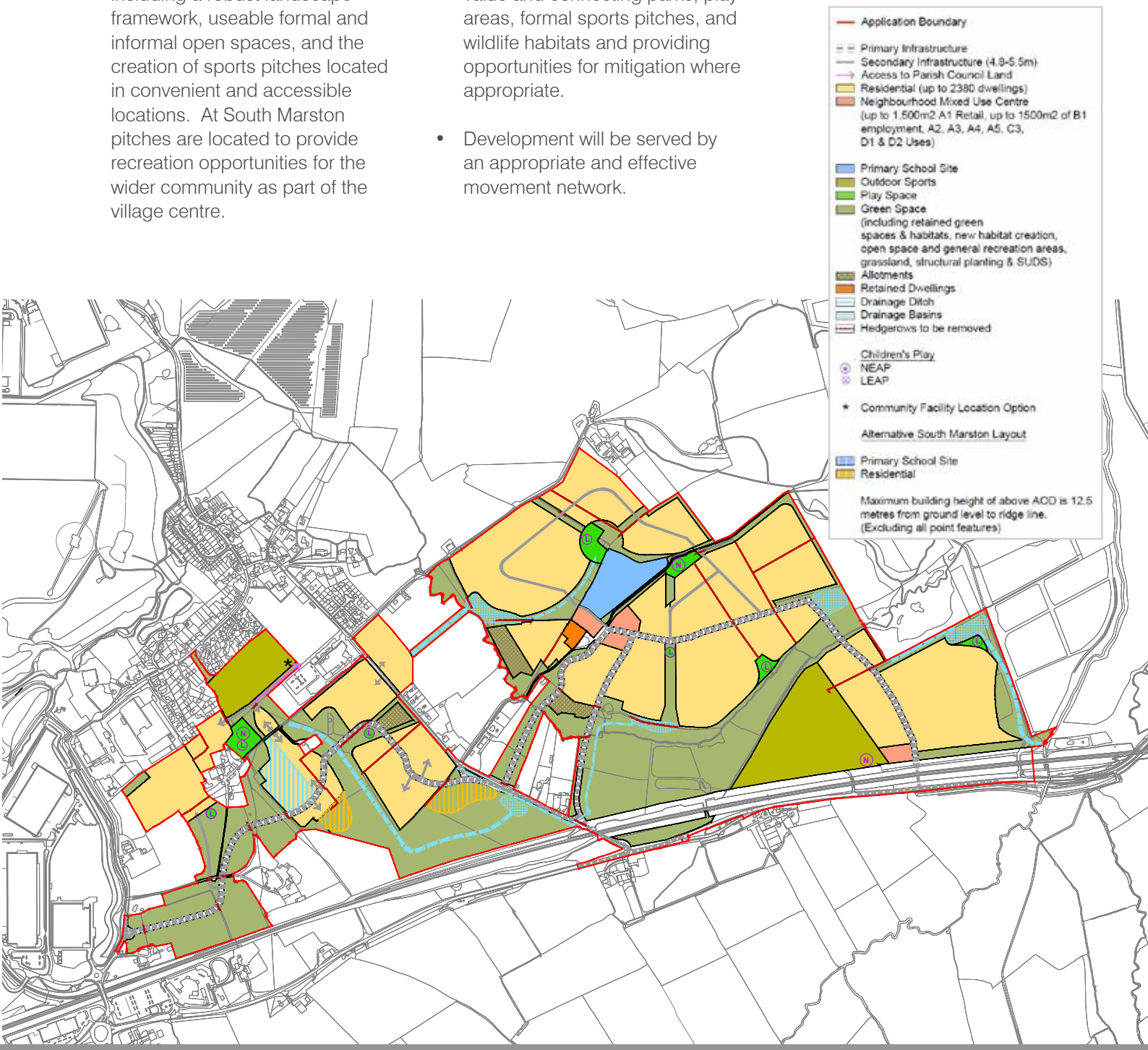


Fig 010 : Development Framework Plan

Proposed Landscape Zones

The GIF framework equates to some 65ha or c.40% of the site. The design of the green infrastructure will be carried forward in detailed reserved matters submissions. However in indicative terms the green infrastructure comprises the following broad elements.

1) The creation of a large multifunctional landscape habitat within the Proposed Development. Although on 'the ground' this will be observed a single extensive and connected area of greenspace offering a variety of uses and habitats it is, for ease, separated into three areas to aid explanation See Green Infrastructure Framework (GIF) - Guiding Principles, for locations).

   - **Zone 1:** South Marston. This is located to the west of Old Vicarage Lane. It encompasses a number of retained trees, hedges and rights of way, together with new habitat creation in the form of new broadleaved planting of woodland copses, hedges and trees and grassland meadows and SUDS (basins and swales). The area will include new sports pitches (alongside the existing recreation ground), and areas of equipped play.

   - **Zone 2:** Rowborough. This lies to the east of Old Vicarage Lane and is broadly defined by South Marston Brook. It encompasses the Brook and its associated tree cover and floodplain, as well as retained trees, hedgerows and rights of way. It also includes new sports provision, (albeit in this location more informal in nature complementing more formal provision in the Nightingale area) equipped play areas and habitat creation in the form of new broadleaved planting, SUDS (and grassland meadows).

   - **Zone 3:** Nightingale. This lies to the south east of the site and comprises sports pitches, allotments and habitat creation which include SUDS.

2) "Greenways" and "Pocket Parks". These are defined corridors or areas of natural greenspace that essentially connect with the three parks. They contain existing hedgerows and trees and deliver opportunities for habitat creation in the form of new planting, as well providing informal recreation to include walking and natural play.

3) Retained mature trees within the development parcels, which provide an opportunity in which to deliver feature spaces within the detailed layout.

4) New street trees and pockets of incidental greenspace and planting within development parcels, in addition to private gardens.

The key zones are illustrated in indicative form on the following pages.

While the majority of green infrastructure is likely to be accessible and managed by collection of an Estate Rent Charge, the details of such arrangements remain to be finalised.

Fig 013: Proposed Landscape Zones

Fig 014: Zone 1 South Marston

Fig 015: South Marston Greenspace Area "Indicative" Zones

Fig 016: Zone 2 Rowborough

Fig 017: Rowborough Greenspace Area 'Indicative' Zones

Fig 018: Zone 3 Nightingale

Fig 019: Nightingale Park Greenspace Area 'Indicative' Zones

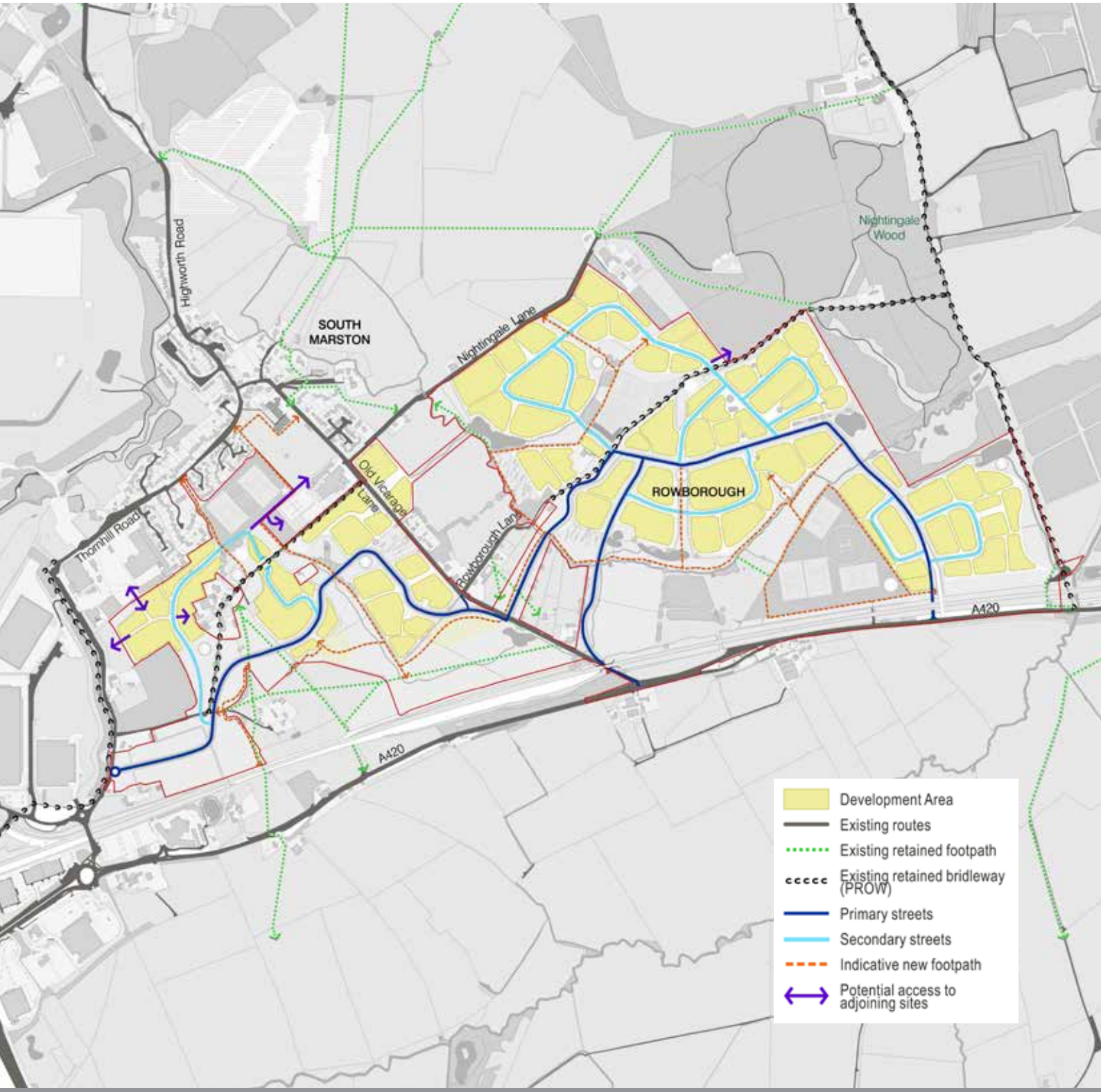
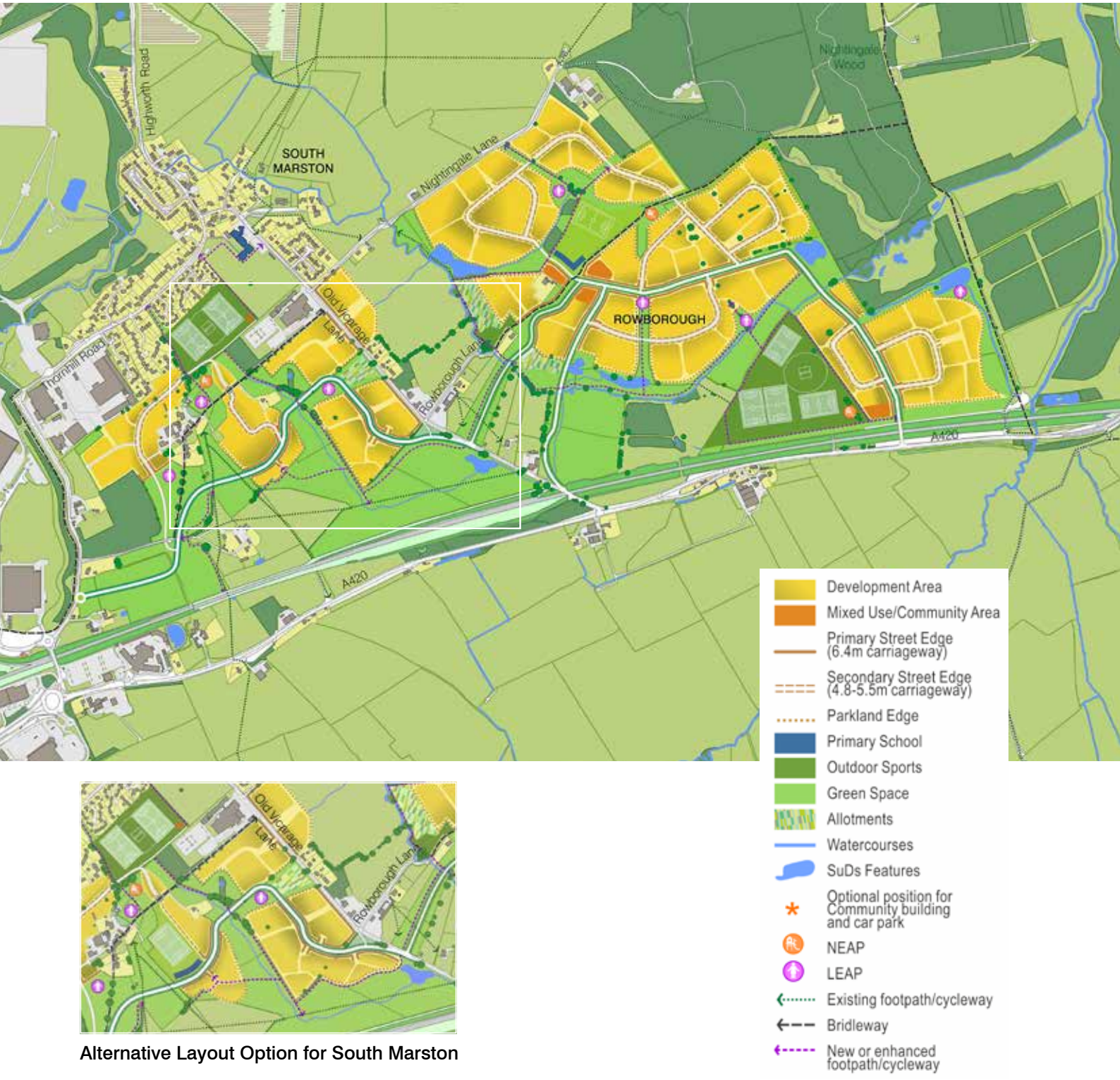


Fig 020 : Indicative Access & Movement Strategy



Alternative Layout Option for South Marston

Fig 021 : Illustrative Master Plan

Eastside
Rowborough Character Areas

The potential Eastside character area may address the north-eastern development edge of Rowborough adjoining Nightingale Wood and areas of open countryside. Design and layout considerations comprise:

- The northern part of the character area is at the highest point of Rowborough with land falling gently to the south and west.
- Given the topography, with views out towards South Marston and the wider New Eastern Villages area to the south, and location adjoining Nightingale Wood, a more informal development layout may be appropriate. This will help to define the eastern edge of Rowborough and accord with the landscape proposals in the area.
- Visual and physical linkages will also be provided along existing hedgerow, footpaths and bridleways into Nightingale Wood from Rowborough.
- Development densities are likely to be lower at the edge of the character area. Dispersed groupings of principally detached houses will provide one appropriate boundary to the village.
- A design response will establish development frontages to parts of Nightingale Wood, with areas of informal landscape planting providing a suitable interface. Elsewhere alternative approaches will be appropriate.
- To Nightingale Lane and the north east corner of the site private garden areas will adjoin the site boundaries where existing robust hedgerows will be retained and enhanced.
- Playspaces will be accommodated within the landscape framework as well as opportunities for informal recreation and habitat creation.
- Detailed design and layout will have regard to the setting of Nightingale Farmhouse.

Alternative schematic options have however been identified and are described below

While one option is to accommodate a community building and/or facilities on land owned by the Parish Council adjacent to (and not within) the application site, the application proposals provide for such provision within the application site should this prove to be the most appropriate means by which such community facilities can be provided or that such facilities as are necessary cannot or do not come forward on the Parish Council land.

A location is shown within the application site demonstrating that the likely requirements in respect of the village centre may be delivered in an appropriate manner as part of the application proposals.

A further element of the proposals for the village centre is the nature and range of sports facilities.

Whilst the drawings illustrate the planned expansion of the existing primary school, in the eventuality that such planned expansion did not proceed then alternative provision is made in the application site.

Community Building location within application site

1 This scenario shows a new community building and associated parking within the application site, co-located adjacent to the Parish Council recreation land.

Permission is sought for these two alternative locations as part of the application proposals.

Manor Green

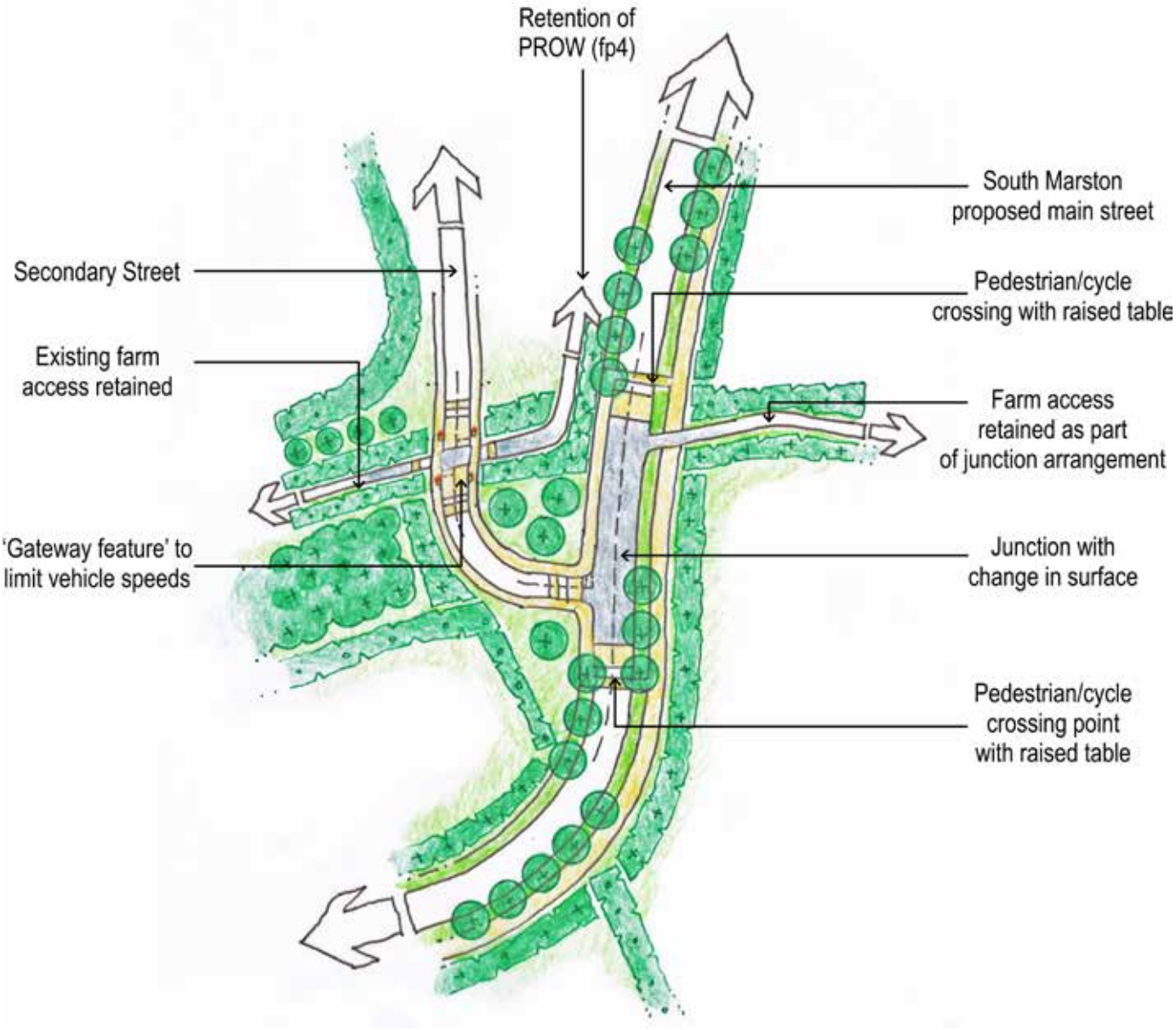
South Marston Character Areas

The Manor Green area will provide an attractive residential location within the expanded South Marston. Design and layout considerations will include:

- The character will reflect the informal layout of the retained buildings around Manor Farm. Tree and landscape planting providing a setting for development.
- Frontage development along streets with potential for groups of housing around shared-streets.
- A variety of densities will be included through the character area with a mix of detached and semi-detached houses but also some medium densities.
- An important feature of Manor Green will be the interface between development and the main areas of formal and informal space that characterise the village expansion area.
- Development that fronts onto adjoining open space areas will provide opportunities for overlooking and passive surveillance to take place.
- Retained trees and hedgerows will provide a strong framework for the open spaces, with opportunities for additional tree planting.
- Local and neighbourhood standard play areas will be accommodated close to the main area of formal playing pitches adjoining the village centre.
- Detailed design and layout will have regard to the setting of the Red House.
- Proposals adjacent to Manor Farm will demonstrate application of appropriate design as part of reserved matters applications.

South Marston Main Street Character Area

The first junction at the western part of Main Street will provide access to the Manor Green character area as well existing buildings around Manor Farmhouse and South Marston Farm. The junction will need to incorporate both existing and proposed access points as well as provide pedestrian and cycle access and accomodate existing movements along PROW (fp4). The illustrative design demonstrates one potential layout which maintains accessibility and also provides extensive landscape and tree planting, hedgerow retention and enhancement, and will add to the character of this part of the proposed Main Street.



David Lock Associates
Town Planning and Urban Design

50 North Thirteenth Street Central Milton Keynes Bucks MK9 3BP